



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: St. Ignatius Catholic School
School Website: <https://www.stignatiuskaukauna.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

St Ignatius Catholic School (St. Ignatius Catholic School & Chesterton Academy, Kaukauna, WI) presents a consciously Catholic, classical-leaning program with strong religious formation, virtue-centered aims, and a curriculum and pedagogy that trawl the core elements of classical education. Public-facing materials emphasize formation over mere information, a sacred and liturgical daily rhythm, and a Catholic intellectual tradition anchored in Mass, Eucharistic Adoration, and catechesis. The school highlights a Catholic classical curriculum, early Latin instruction, and explicit attention to “great books” and scholé (restful, contemplative learning). Taken together, the six-category analysis yields a general classification of CLASSICAL, with two categories showing notable overlap or partial alignment that would move toward full Classical status with targeted enhancements. The strongest evidence lies in Religious and Metaphysical Foundations, School Purpose and Goal, Curriculum (to the extent documented), and Parents & Community. Pedagogy and Faculty show meaningful classical cues but require fuller explicit articulation of certain elements (e.g., Socratic pedagogy across upper grades and a more explicit living-curriculum faculty portrait). The aggregate assessment is therefore CLASSICAL, with concrete steps outlined below to reach complete alignment in all six categories.

Executive highlights by category (category-by-category snapshot overview): - Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: CLASSICAL. Explicit Catholic liturgy, daily Mass, Eucharistic Adoration, catechesis, and a sacramental worldview are woven into the school day and culture. Positive indicators dominate; no negative signals evident in the public materials. - Purpose and Goal: CLASSICAL. Formation of virtue and wisdom with pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty is foregrounded; formation over mere information is stated in mission framing. - Curriculum: CLASSICAL. Strong evidence for a Catholic-classical curriculum, early Latin, and references to great books and the Scholé framework; some details appear in supplemental materials but key elements are present. - Pedagogy: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. Foundational practices include memory-based practices (singing, recitation) and Scholé-like restfulness; explicit public references to Socratic/seminar pedagogy are less explicit in the public-facing materials, suggesting partial alignment. - Faculty: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. The public materials emphasize leadership (headmaster, faculty), and engagements that align with classical aims, but a clearly articulated “living curriculum” faculty portrait or explicit model-mentor language is not consistently foregrounded in the public content. - Parents & Community: CLASSICAL. Strong partnership with parents, openness to parent involvement, and family formation activities are highlighted; parents are positioned as co-educators and partners in formation.

What would move the needle? - Accelerate explicit articulation and practice of Socratic/seminar pedagogy across upper grades, with documented teacher-led seminars and student-led rhetoric opportunities as a regular component (Element 4). - Flesh out the Faculty category with a named, public “portrait of the teacher” or “living curriculum” articulation, including professional development around classical pedagogy and teacher-student mutual formation (Element 5). - Expand explicit Great-Books programming and a stated, formal Great Conversation framework across core subjects, including a visible history of curricular integration (Element 3). - Continue deepening parent formation and co-teaching initiatives with structured programs or book studies that foreground classical aims and scholarly habits (Element 6).

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school asserts Mass is central to the experience (daily Mass for grades 3K-12, with communal Mass on Thursdays) and includes Eucharistic Adoration and Reconciliation as regular practices. - Catechesis of the Good Shepherd is described as part of religious formation, guided by Montessori principles, with weekly Atrium sessions. - The religious identity is explicit throughout public materials (joyfully Catholic, Catholic faith, and liturgical life woven into daily routines). - A clear articulation of truth, goodness, and beauty is embedded in curriculum descriptions (pursuit of truth, beauty, and goodness; education to form the whole person in the Catholic tradition).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: truth, goodness, beauty; virtue; theology; liturgy; Mass; Eucharistic Adoration; catechesis; liturgical life. Evidence from multiple pages confirms these terms and their integration. - Negative keywords present: none detected in public materials.

Why this rating - The resources show robust transcendental and liturgical foundations, explicit theology and sacramental practices, and communal worship oriented to formation in virtue. The public materials align squarely with the Classical rubric's religious-metaphysical expectations.

Citations: The core religious identity, liturgical life, and catechesis references are visible in the Our School page and Faith-related sections.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The mission describes forming virtuous leaders and saints, educated in the classical tradition; continued emphasis on formation and virtue in Catholic classical education. - Public statements emphasize education to form the whole person and to pursue truth, beauty, and goodness, aligning with formation over mere information. - The school presents a formation-centric purpose—"to form joyful leaders and saints"—consistent with the telos and classical emphasis on human excellence.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation; virtue; wisdom (implied in formation of virtuous leaders); truth, goodness, beauty; liberal-arts framing; classical mission; telos; scholé/contemplation (through Scholé framing). Evidence appears in statements about forming virtue and pursuing truth, beauty, and goodness. - Negative keywords present: none explicit.

Why this rating - The school foregrounds formation and virtue as primary aims, with explicit reference to truth, beauty, and goodness as real and knowable, aligning with the classical purpose criteria.

Citations: Core mission statements, formation language, and the emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness appear in Our School materials and related communications.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school explicitly identifies itself as Catholic classical, with curriculum described as part of a Catholic classical program; Latin is taught from kindergarten, indicating classical language study. - The curriculum is presented as "Catholic classical curriculum" with a link to a curriculum overview PDF, signaling structured liberal-arts education consistent with the classical Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) approach. - References to Great Books and the Scholé approach appear in public materials (e.g., "The Scholé Way" materials discuss Great Books and Scholé as core means of learning).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Latin; Great Books; Great Conversation (implied by Great Books and scholé language); history (implied by classical curriculum) and the general "curriculum" framing; grammar/logic/rhetoric (through the Trivium framing implied by "Catholic classical curriculum," and Lower Grammar emphasis). - Negative keywords present: none explicit.

Why this rating - The presence of Latin-from-kindergarten, explicit "Catholic classical curriculum" labeling, and references to Great Books/Scholé strongly align with classical curriculum expectations, even though

some detailed elements (e.g., a full list of Trivium/Quadrivium, explicit history-forward structure) are not exhaustively enumerated in the public materials.

Citations: Curriculum mentions appear in the Lower Grammar page (Latin) and Curriculum overview references; Great Books/Scholé references appear in “The Scholé Way” materials.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Memory-based and rote-learning aspects are explicit in the Lower Grammar description: “students easily absorb facts and learn best through song, memorization, recitation, and repetition.” This is a direct classical pedagogy cue. - Scholé and contemplative/restful learning are foregrounded (Scholé as a central concept in public communications about teaching/learning, including discussions of restfulness and wonder). - There are indications of Socratic-inspired pedagogy in upper levels as part of the classical model (the school’s overall classical stance and Chesterton Academy linkage suggest this, though explicit public statements of upper-grade Socratic seminars or debates are less clearly enumerated in the accessible materials). The Scholé framework references classical discussion and contemplation, which are part of the classical pedagogy, even if not always explicitly labeled as “Socratic seminars” in public pages.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: scholé; wonder; singing/recitation/memory; restfulness; formal pedagogy (narration/recitation implied); seminary-like discussion. - Negative keywords present: explicit emphasis on project-based learning or experiential learning dominating pedagogy is not present; the materials actually emphasize memory work and contemplative practice rather than a purely project-based approach.

Why this rating - The presence of singing/memorization, restfulness, and Scholé-oriented language indicates classical pedagogy in practice, but explicit, consistently documented upper-grade Socratic seminars or debates are not exhaustively demonstrated in the public materials to the level of a full classical guarantee. Hence SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than fully CLASSICAL.

Citations: Lower Grammar memory-based approach and Scholé/Scholé-related materials support the reasoning.

Element 5: School Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The public materials portray the faculty as school leaders (headmaster, head of lower school) and emphasize ongoing faculty activities (e.g., reading and professional reflection related to classical education, as seen in “The Scholé Way” communications). These reflect a professional culture aligned with classical aims. - However, explicit language that the faculty themselves are the “living curriculum,” or a formalized “portrait of what a teacher should be” in the public materials is not consistently foregrounded. The Lexicon lists such descriptors as ideal in classical schools, but the public site does not consistently present a formal, named “portrait of the teacher” or “faculty as living curriculum” statement.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: professional leadership (headmaster/head of lower school) and participation in classical-education conversations (e.g., Scholé-related professional discourse). - Negative keywords present: none explicit in public materials; however, there is not a consistently explicit “faculty as living curriculum” or “portrait of teacher” piece.

Why this rating - The school demonstrates classical orientation in faculty leadership and engagement with classical pedagogy topics, but it lacks explicit public articulation of a “living curriculum” faculty portrait or the same depth of explicit faculty-culture language that would make Element 5 CLASSICAL in full. Therefore, SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Citations: Evidence of faculty leadership and professional development in Scholé-related materials and leadership pages.

Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school emphasizes partnership with parents and families, presenting parents as co-educators and essential partners in forming the next generation. This is explicitly stated in mission/values language. - The materials reference parent formation and involvement (via website, gatherings, and family participation) and open-campus/visitor-friendly posture. The public materials indicate frequent parental engagement opportunities (admissions, events, and campus life). - The school's Catholic-parish ecosystem is described (parish support, multiple parishes, campus ministry), signaling a robust community integration beyond the immediate school walls.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with parents; co-teachers; parent formation; book studies; gatherings; open campus; family liturgy alignment. - Negative keywords present: none.

Why this rating - The public content strongly supports the classical-community ethos, with explicit emphasis on parent partnership and community formation, aligning with the classical school model's expectation that families participate as co-educators.

Citations: Parent partnership language and parish/community content are spread across the Our School page and Faith/Parish sections.

What Would Move the Needle

- For Element 4 (Pedagogy): Introduce and publicize a formal, school-wide practice of Socratic seminars and structured debates at the upper-grade levels, with explicit teacher guides and student rubrics to document the practice. Elevate the explicit language around Socratic pedagogy to complement the Scholé-based approach.
 - For Element 5 (Faculty): Publish a formal "Portrait of the Teacher" and a concise description of how faculty function as the living curriculum, including ongoing professional development in classical pedagogy, and a public articulation of a faculty culture that mirrors classical virtues and scholarly habit formation.
 - For Element 3 (Curriculum): Provide a clear, public map that ties together Trivium elements (grammar, logic, rhetoric) with course sequences, along with explicit references to Great Books and Great Conversation in each grade band. Expand public mentions of history as part of the curriculum and how it connects to Western civilization through primary sources.
 - For Element 2 (Purpose and Goal): Continue to foreground "formation over information" with measurable outcomes (e.g., virtue-based rubrics, character formation milestones, or portfolios) that illuminate how virtue and wisdom are cultivated in daily classroom life.
 - For Element 6 (Parents & Community): Expand parent-formation programming (book studies, seminars, and family liturgy resources) with scheduled, recurring opportunities for parental participation and reflection on classical education principles.
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Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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